

Healey picks insider for medical board

Patient groups question choice of Rosenbloom, call for stricter oversight

By Elizabeth Koh and Liz Kowalczyk
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey has appointed an industry insider and university professor to represent the public on the state's medical board, which has come under scrutiny for its lax approach to disciplining problem doctors.

David Rosenbloom, 81, was tapped late last month to fill a long-vacant seat on the seven-person Board of Registration in Medicine. He ran Boston's public health system in the late 1970s and '80s, and later led a health care data analytics company, as well as a health insurance plan for people with severe medical conditions. He also serves as an emeritus professor at Boston University's School of Public Health, where he has focused on substance use disorder treatment and policy.

Rosenbloom, of Boston, will fill one of two seats reserved for non-doctors on the board. The other public slot is held by a national security and defense consultant, and the remaining positions are occupied by veteran physicians.

Healey spokesperson Karissa Hand said in an email that Rosenbloom was appointed to the oversight board "because of his extensive experience in public health and his commitment to upholding high standards for physicians."

Hand declined to answer questions about why the seat was vacant for more than a year.

Last month, the Globe Spotlight Team published an investigation that found the board is slow to act and has become more lax in holding physicians to account. Discipline rates since

MEDICAL BOARD, Page A6

Assisted-living panel backs more oversight

Recommendations follow devastating Fall River fire

By Travis Andersen and Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

A panel on Monday unanimously approved recommendations to boost state oversight of assisted-living homes following a devastating fire that killed 10 people at a Fall River facility in July.

The recommendations by the Assisted Living Residences Commission call for improved staffing guidance, fuller disclosure to customers of costs, fees, refund policies, and violations, and regular assessments of residents' social, physical, medical, and cognitive needs so workers can more easily evacuate them in emergencies.

"These recommendations and our ability to implement them will make a real difference in the lives of the people who are served and who reside in assisted-living residences," said Robin Lipson, the state's chief official for elder services, after the panel's vote.

The reform process got underway in 2024 in re-

ASSISTED LIVING, Page A7

Trump faces blowback as probe of Fed chief roils Washington



HEATHER DIEHL/GETTY IMAGES

Senator Elizabeth Warren, Democrat from Massachusetts, spoke with President Trump Monday about rising prices.

Warren slams president; economists say Powell investigation could backfire

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — With Americans still struggling with the high cost of living, President Trump has scrambled recently to show he's working on the problem: calling for a cap on credit card interest rates, touting efforts to make housing more affordable, and even framing the US military's removal of Venezuela's leader as a way to lower gas prices.

But arguably the biggest step

by his administration to try to reduce costs was revealed Sunday night by Federal Reserve chair Jerome Powell, who announced that the Justice Department was conducting a criminal investigation into whether he had lied to Congress about the central bank's renovation of its historic Washington headquarters.

Powell, who has faced calls from Trump to resign for not lowering interest rates more aggressively, said in a short video that

the inquiry was simply a pretext for an attack on him and the independent Fed for refusing to bend to the administration.

The move by the Trump administration was met with strong criticism Monday from Democrats in Congress and some Republicans in another sign of rising GOP discontent. And the apparent attempt to pressure Powell ultimately could backfire, economists warned, with higher inflation possible if the Fed keeps interest rates

lower than needed.

"I think Donald Trump is starting to sweat. He understands how much economic stress families are under, and he knows he's got to turn this around," said Senator Elizabeth Warren, a Massachusetts Democrat. "So he may be hoping that he can juice the economy by getting his hands on the interest rate levers and lowering interest rates dramatically so there's a big burst of economic en-

FEDERAL RESERVE, Page A5

A crack in supportive housing foundation

Federal cuts threaten to undermine progress fighting homelessness

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

On Washington Street in Jamaica Plain, a modern-looking apartment building is Pine Street Inn's latest bid to end homelessness in Boston.

The five-story building looks much like the luxury apartment complexes cropping up across the region, where rents regularly top \$3,000 a month. But instead of well-off

20- and 30-somethings, this place is home to people who were chronically homeless not long ago, the sort of people cities such as Boston have long struggled to help.

Here, the people live in their own apartments and have access to supportive services including case workers and counseling, all under the same roof. This model of pairing housing and support services — most commonly known as permanent supportive housing — has successfully housed some of the city's most vulnerable residents, keeping people with severe mental and physical disabilities and those who struggle with addiction off the street and

\$3.6B
The amount of money distributed by the US Department of Housing and Urban Development last year for homeless programs

\$136M
Of those dollars went to Massachusetts

HOUSING, Page A7

Morrissey won't seek reelection as Norfolk DA

By Laura Crimaldi, Sean Cotter, and Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

Norfolk District Attorney Michael W. Morrissey on Monday announced he will not seek reelection, ending a 50-year career in elected office that has brought him from the State House to the county's top law enforcement position but was punctuated by public outcry over his prosecution of Karen Read and his handling of the investigation into Sandra Birchmore's death.

Morrissey wrote in a statement that he was proud of his work in office, but that "the time is right for me to start a new chapter in my life."

"Being district attorney is about pursuing justice with integrity and fairness. I am incredibly proud of the meaningful work our office has accomplished, both in the courtroom and throughout the community," Morrissey wrote in a state-

ment.

Morrissey's decision followed months of relative public silence from the Quincy Democrat, who was first elected Norfolk district attorney in 2010.

Last year, he skipped Read's trial, which ended in her acquittal. In December, he appeared in Norfolk Superior Court as a jury convicted Brian Walshe of first-degree murder in the killing of his wife in Cohasset, one of the most high-profile cases under Morrissey's tenure. He told reporters then he "couldn't be happier" about the verdict, but declined to discuss his future.

With Morrissey out of the picture, four Democratic candidates hope to appear on the primary ballot in September.

They are defense attorney Jim Barakat, former federal prosecutor Adam Deitch, Craig MacLellan, a Cohasset School Committee member and former

MORRISSEY, Page A6

PATRIOTS TO PLAY TEXANS NEXT



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Wide receiver Efton Chism III celebrated a catch in the New England Patriots win against the Los Angeles Chargers Sunday. The Patriots will play the Houston Texans Sunday in the divisional round of the playoffs. The Texans beat the Steelers to advance. **C1.**



Plops in for a visit

Tuesday: Sun early, rain late. High 41-46, low 35-40.

Wednesday: Sprinkles, mild. High 47-52, low 35-40.

Sunrise: 7:12. Sunset: 4:34

Weather and comics, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

Governor Maura Healey chose a Mass General Brigham doctor to be the state's next veterans services secretary. B1.

Nearly 15,000 nurses went on strike in New York City, threatening to upend patient care at some of its top hospitals. A2.

Lawmakers are calling for the state to take Norwood Hospital by eminent domain in a bid to reopen the former Steward facility. **D1.**

President Trump reportedly is exploring both diplomatic and military options with Iran amid a bloody crackdown on protesters in that nation. **A3.**

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